

Word family: **runway / runways**

I'll keep the same full-family sweep used in your fullest reference: ordinary meanings first, then lexicalized compounds, specialist fields, distinctions, low-frequency senses, and finally the recommended semantic merge.

Base word: runway

Plural: runways

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

There is no important ordinary modern verb *to runway*. Most extensions use **runway** attributively:

- * runway lighting
- * runway model
- * runway show
- * runway collection
- * runway safety
- * runway capacity
- * runway length
- * runway incursion
- * runway excursion
- * cash runway
- * startup runway
- * crane runway
- * athletics runway

Your passage:

> “Instead, use the promotion to **build a runway**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **runway** is figurative.

It means:

> **enough accumulated money, preparation time, and financial breathing room to allow Kam Chai to move from his salaried job toward opening the café without immediately running into financial crisis.**

The image comes from an aircraft runway:

> aircraft needs enough runway to accelerate safely before takeoff

> → entrepreneur needs enough money/time/preparation before launching a business.

****繁體中文：****

*** **創業緩衝期****

*** **財務跑道****

*** **足夠的資金與準備時間****

*** **讓創業計劃有時間起飛的財務基礎****

For natural prose, I would translate:

> “use the promotion to build a runway”

as:

****「利用這次升職累積足夠的資金與準備時間，為日後創業鋪好跑道。」****

The literal 「跑道」 metaphor can be preserved because the writer later says:

> “those who prepare so well that the leap becomes smaller.”

So the passage has a deliberate movement/launch metaphor.

A. RUNWAY = AIRCRAFT TAKEOFF/LANDING SURFACE

1. ****runway = prepared strip on which aircraft take off and land (飛機跑道)****

This is the dominant literal modern meaning.

> “The plane taxied towards the runway.”

「飛機滑行前往****跑道****。」

> “The aircraft landed safely on the runway.”

「飛機安全降落在****跑道****上。」

A runway is a designated prepared surface for aircraft takeoff and landing; it is not another word for the entire airport. ([劍橋詞典][1])

B. PAVED / UNPAVED RUNWAY

2. ****paved runway = 鋪設路面的跑道****

May use materials such as:

- * asphalt
- * concrete

depending on airport.

3. **unpaved runway = 未鋪裝跑道**

May have surfaces such as:

- * grass
- * gravel
- * dirt

depending on airfield.

4. **grass runway = 草地跑道**

Common at smaller airfields.

C. RUNWAY LENGTH / WIDTH

5. **runway length = 跑道長度**

A major aviation parameter because aircraft takeoff/landing requirements depend partly on:

- * aircraft type
- * weight
- * weather
- * altitude
- * surface condition

among other factors.

6. **runway width = 跑道寬度**

D. RUNWAY NUMBER / DESIGNATOR

7. **runway number / runway designator = 跑道編號**

Runways are identified by numerical designators related to their directional orientation; parallel runways may also use letters such as **L, C, R** for left, centre, and right. FAA operational terminology uses forms such as **RWY 03L / 03C / 03R**. ([美國聯邦航空管理局][2])

Examples:

- * Runway 09
- * Runway 27
- * Runway 03L

E. PARALLEL RUNWAYS

8. **parallel runways = 平行跑道**

An airport may have two or more approximately parallel runways.

Possible identifiers:

- * L = left
- * C = centre
- * R = right.

F. CROSSWIND RUNWAY

9. **crosswind runway = 側風跑道 / 供不同風向使用的跑道**

A runway oriented differently from another runway so aircraft operations can better accommodate alternative wind directions.

G. RUNWAY THRESHOLD

10. **runway threshold = 跑道入口 / 著陸跑道起始門檻**

The threshold marks the beginning of the part of the runway available for landing in that direction.

H. DISPLACED THRESHOLD

11. **displaced threshold = 內移跑道入口 / 移位跑道門檻**

A threshold positioned beyond the physical beginning of the runway.

This reduces runway length available for landing from that direction, while the preceding portion may still be usable for certain other operations. FAA guidance explicitly makes this distinction. ([美國聯邦航空管理局][3])

I. RUNWAY END

12. **runway end = 跑道末端**

The physical/end portion of a runway.

J. RUNWAY CENTRELINE / CENTERLINE

13. **runway centreline = 跑道中線**

The line running along the longitudinal centre of a runway.

Used in:

- * markings
- * lighting
- * aircraft alignment.

K. RUNWAY EDGE

14. **runway edge = 跑道邊緣**

L. RUNWAY SHOULDER

15. **runway shoulder = 跑道道肩**

Surface alongside the runway designed to support/protect the runway edge and reduce damage from aircraft excursions or jet blast depending on design.

M. RUNWAY MARKINGS

16. **runway markings = 跑道標誌**

Can include markings for:

- * centreline
- * threshold
- * designation
- * aiming point
- * touchdown zone

depending on runway type.

N. RUNWAY LIGHTS / LIGHTING

17. **runway lighting = 跑道燈光系統**

Helps pilots identify/alignment/use runways, especially:

- * at night
- * in reduced visibility.

18. **runway edge lights = 跑道邊燈**

19. **runway centreline lights = 跑道中線燈**

20. **runway threshold lights = 跑道入口燈**

O. RUNWAY VISUAL RANGE

21. **runway visual range / RVR = 跑道視程**

An aviation visibility measure representing the distance a pilot can expect to see along the runway using runway lighting or visual targets under specified measurement conditions. ([美國聯邦航空管理局][4])

Highly specialist.

P. RUNWAY SAFETY AREA

22. **runway safety area / RSA = 跑道安全區**

An area around/beyond the runway designed to reduce consequences if an aircraft:

- * leaves the runway
- * overruns
- * undershoots.

FAA guidance specifically describes runway safety areas as a primary mitigation for runway excursions. ([美國聯邦航空管理局][5])

Q. RUNWAY STRIP

23. **runway strip = 跑道地帶 / 跑道帶**

A defined area surrounding a runway under aviation standards.

Do not automatically equate it with:

> the paved runway surface itself.

R. RUNWAY INCURSION

24. **runway incursion = 跑道入侵事件**

A major aviation-safety term.

Broadly, it refers to an incorrect presence of an:

- * aircraft

* vehicle

* person

on the protected area associated with a runway used for takeoff/landing. ([美國聯邦航空管理局][6])

Example:

> a vehicle accidentally enters an active runway.

S. RUNWAY EXCURSION

25. **runway excursion = 跑道偏出 / 衝出事件**

An aircraft:

* veers off the side;

* overruns the end;

* or in broader safety treatment lands short/adjacent,

during landing or takeoff operations. ([美國聯邦航空管理局][5])

T. RUNWAY OVERRUN

26. **runway overrun = 衝出跑道末端**

Aircraft continues past the runway end.

This is one type of runway excursion.

U. RUNWAY UNDERSHOOT

27. **runway undershoot = 未達跑道便著地 / 落在跑道前方**

Aircraft lands short of the intended runway surface.

V. RUNWAY VEER-OFF

28. **runway veer-off = 偏離跑道側面**

Aircraft leaves the side of the runway.

W. ACTIVE RUNWAY / RUNWAY IN USE

29. **active runway = 正在使用的跑道**

Common everyday aviation expression for the runway currently being used for takeoffs/landings.

Formal operational wording may instead prefer:

> runway in use

depending on context.

X. CLOSED RUNWAY

30. **closed runway = 關閉的跑道**

Unavailable for aircraft operations because of:

- * maintenance
- * obstruction
- * construction
- * emergency
- * other operational reason.

Y. RUNWAY CLOSURE

31. **runway closure = 跑道關閉**

Z. WET / DRY / CONTAMINATED RUNWAY

32. **dry runway = 乾跑道**

33. **wet runway = 濕跑道**

34. **contaminated runway = 受污染跑道**

Possible contamination includes specified amounts/types of:

- * standing water
- * snow
- * ice
- * slush

under aviation definitions.

These conditions can affect aircraft braking/performance.

AA. RUNWAY CONDITION

35. **runway condition = 跑道狀況**

Can concern:

- * friction
- * contamination
- * surface condition
- * availability.

AB. RUNWAY CAPACITY

36. **runway capacity = 跑道容量 / 可處理航班能力**

How many aircraft movements a runway or runway system can accommodate under specified operational conditions.

AC. RUNWAY OCCUPANCY

37. **runway occupancy = 航機佔用跑道的時間 / 狀態**

38. **runway occupancy time = 跑道佔用時間**

Important in airport-capacity and air-traffic management.

AD. RUNWAY HOLDING POSITION

39. **runway holding position = 跑道等待位置**

A designated point where aircraft/vehicles must normally stop until authorized to enter/cross the runway.

AE. RUNWAY CLEARANCE

40. **runway clearance**

Can refer contextually to:

- * ATC authorization involving runway use;
- * physical clearance/separation around runway.

The intended meaning must be determined from context.

AF. RUNWAY AVAILABLE DISTANCE

Aviation uses several highly technical declared-distance measures.

41. **takeoff run available / TORA**

Distance declared available for the ground run of an aircraft taking off.

42. **takeoff distance available / TODA**

Declared takeoff distance incorporating specified additional area under applicable standards.

43. **accelerate-stop distance available / ASDA**

Distance available for an aircraft to accelerate and, if necessary, stop.

44. **landing distance available / LDA**

Declared runway length available for landing.

These belong to technical aviation, not general vocabulary.

AG. RUNWAY VS TAXIWAY

Very important.

runway

primarily used for:

> takeoff and landing.

taxiway

used for aircraft ground movement between:

- * runway
- * apron
- * terminal
- * hangar.

A plane normally:

- > taxis **on a taxiway**
- > takes off **from a runway**.

AH. RUNWAY VS APRON / RAMP

runway

takeoff/landing surface.

apron / ramp

area where aircraft may:

- * park
- * board

* refuel

* load.

AI. RUNWAY VS AIRSTRIP

runway

specific takeoff/landing surface.

airstrip

often a small/simple landing area, sometimes consisting mainly of one runway.

They overlap, but:

> airport runway ≠ necessarily airstrip.

AJ. RUNWAY VS LANDING STRIP

landing strip

broad/informal strip where aircraft take off/land.

runway

standard general/technical airport term.

AK. ATHLETICS: RUNWAY

A second important literal branch.

45. **runway = approach track on which an athlete accelerates before a jump or throw (助跑道) **

In athletics, competitors use a runway to build speed before certain events.

World Athletics explicitly uses **runway** for long jump, triple jump, pole vault, and javelin facilities.
([世界田徑][7])

AL. LONG-JUMP RUNWAY

46. **long-jump runway = 跳遠助跑道**

Athletes sprint along it before reaching the:

> take-off board.

At elite level, World Athletics describes the long-jump runway as a dedicated approach surface before the board and landing pit. ([世界田徑][7])

AM. TRIPLE-JUMP RUNWAY

47. **triple-jump runway = 三級跳助跑道**

Same basic approach-track concept.

AN. POLE-VAULT RUNWAY

48. **pole-vault runway = 撐竿跳助跑道**

The athlete accelerates down the runway while carrying/lowering the pole before planting it into the box. ([世界田徑][8])

AO. JAVELIN RUNWAY

49. **javelin runway = 標槍助跑道**

The athlete runs along it before throwing the javelin.

AP. HIGH-JUMP RUNWAY / APPROACH AREA

50. **high-jump runway / approach area**

Technical facility documents may refer to the high-jump approach as a runway, although everyday coaching often simply says:

> approach / run-up.

World Athletics facility documents include high jump among jump runways. ([世界田徑][9])

AQ. RUNWAY VS TRACK — ATHLETICS

track

oval/running surface used for races.

runway

straight/specially defined approach area used to build speed before a jump/throw.

A long jumper runs down a runway, not around the competition track as part of the jump.

AR. FASHION: RUNWAY = CATWALK

51. **runway = long narrow platform/path along which fashion models walk (時裝天橋 ; 伸展台)**

Especially AmE.

Cambridge labels this fashion sense chiefly American and gives **catwalk** as the corresponding synonym. ([劍橋詞典][1])

> “The model walked down the runway.”

「模特兒走上**時裝天橋 / 伸展台**。」

AS. RUNWAY SHOW

52. **runway show = 時裝天橋騷 / 時裝秀**

A fashion show in which models present clothing by walking the runway.

AT. RUNWAY MODEL

53. **runway model = 時裝天橋模特兒**

A model specializing in live fashion-show presentation.

Contrast:

* runway model

* editorial model

* commercial model

depending on fashion-industry context.

AU. WALK THE RUNWAY

54. **walk the runway = 走時裝天橋**

> “She walked the runway in Paris.”

「她在巴黎的時裝秀上**走天橋**。」

AV. HIT / TAKE TO THE RUNWAY

55. **hit/take to the runway = 登上時裝天橋**

Fashion-journalism expression.

AW. RUNWAY COLLECTION

56. **runway collection = 時裝秀系列**

A designer's collection presented in a runway show.

AX. RUNWAY LOOK

57. **runway look = 天橋造型**

An outfit/styling appearance shown in a fashion presentation.

AY. RUNWAY FASHION

58. **runway fashion = 天橋時裝**

May be:

- * experimental
- * conceptual
- * dramatic

and not necessarily identical to what is sold unchanged at retail.

AZ. RUNWAY-READY

59. **runway-ready = 適合上時裝天橋的 / 像天橋造型般完成度高的**

Fashion/marketing adjective.

Often figurative:

> polished enough for a fashion show.

BA. FROM RUNWAY TO RETAIL / STREET

60. **from the runway to retail / street = 從天橋設計走向零售 / 街頭流行**

Fashion-industry phrase describing movement of styles from fashion shows into:

- * shops
- * mass market
- * everyday clothing.

BB. RUNWAY VS CATWALK

runway

especially common AmE.

catwalk

especially common BrE and widely understood internationally.

Both can mean the model-walking platform.

But **catwalk** also has an engineering/general meaning:

> narrow elevated walkway,

where **runway** may not be interchangeable.

BC. THEATRE / NIGHTCLUB RUNWAY

61. **runway = narrow platform extending from a stage into an audience (伸出台 / 伸展舞台)
**

The fashion runway is part of this broader stage-platform concept.

Collins records a runway as a narrow platform extending from a stage into the audience, including for fashion shows. ([柯林斯字典API][10])

BD. STARTUP / BUSINESS FINANCE: RUNWAY

Now the branch behind your passage.

62. **runway = amount of time a business can keep operating before its available cash is exhausted (現金跑道 ; 可支撐時間) **

Especially in:

- * startups
- * early-stage companies
- * cash-burning businesses.

Financial sources define **cash runway** as the period a company can continue operating before running out of cash at its current net spending/burn rate. ([Corporate Finance Institute][11])

BE. CASH RUNWAY

63. **cash runway = 現金跑道 / 現金可支撐期**

> “The startup has twelve months of cash runway.”

「這家初創企業的現金大約還能支撐**十二個月**。」

BF. STARTUP RUNWAY

64. **startup runway = 初創企業可維持營運的資金時間**

Same business metaphor.

BG. MONTHS OF RUNWAY

65. **X months of runway = 尚有 X 個月資金可支撐**

> “We have six months of runway left.”

「按目前開支速度，我們的現金大約還可以支撐**六個月**。」

BH. CASH-RUNWAY FORMULA

66. **runway $\approx$ cash available $\div$ monthly net burn**

For a business losing cash each month:

> **cash runway = available cash / monthly net cash burn**

This is the standard simple formula described by business-finance sources. ([Corporate Finance Institute][11])

Example:

Cash:

> \$120,000

Net cash burn:

> \$20,000/month

Runway:

> approximately 6 months.

BI. BURN RATE

67. **burn rate = rate at which cash is being consumed (燒錢速度 / 現金消耗率) **

Closely related but **not the same thing** as runway.

burn rate

money lost per period.

runway

time remaining before cash runs out.

A useful metaphor:

> burn rate = speed

> runway = distance/time remaining.

BJ. GROSS BURN VS NET BURN

68. **gross burn = total cash expenditure per month**

69. **net burn = cash outflow after cash inflows/revenue are taken into account**

Runway calculations often use net burn when measuring actual depletion of cash reserves.
([Corporate Finance Institute][11])

BK. EXTEND THE RUNWAY

70. **extend one's runway = make available cash last longer (延長資金跑道) **

A startup can extend runway by, for example:

* increasing revenue

- * reducing expenditure
- * raising additional capital.

These are the three broad routes described in startup cash-management guidance. ([摩根大通]
[12])

BL. SHORTEN THE RUNWAY

71. **shorten the runway = make cash run out sooner (縮短資金可支撐時間) **

Examples:

- * hiring rapidly
- * higher rent
- * heavy marketing spend

may shorten runway unless offset by additional revenue/funding.

BM. RUN OUT OF RUNWAY

72. **run out of runway = reach the point where cash/resources are exhausted (資金耗盡) **

> “The startup ran out of runway before becoming profitable.”

「這家初創公司在達到盈利前便**耗盡了資金**。」

The aviation metaphor is especially vivid:

> there is no more strip left before the plane must get airborne.

BN. RUNWAY LEFT

73. **runway left = 剩餘可支撐時間**

> “How much runway do we have left?”

「我們的資金還能支撐多久？」

BO. ADD / BUY MORE RUNWAY

74. **add more runway = 增加可支撐時間**

75. **buy runway / buy more runway = 用資金或削支換取更多時間**

Business metaphor:

> obtain enough extra financial capacity to continue operating longer.

BP. FUNDING EXTENDS RUNWAY

76. **funding gives/extends runway**

> “The investment gives the company another year of runway.”

「這筆投資讓公司多了大約一年的**資金緩衝時間**。」

BQ. RUNWAY TO NEXT FUNDING ROUND

77. **runway to the next funding round = 支撐至下一輪融資的時間**

Startup planning concept.

BR. RUNWAY TO A MILESTONE

78. **runway to reach a milestone = 足夠資金讓企業做到下一個重要里程碑**

Examples:

- * product launch
- * regulatory approval
- * profitability
- * target revenue.

BS. RUNWAY TO PROFITABILITY

79. **runway to profitability = 足以支撐至企業達到盈利的資金時間**

> “Does the company have enough runway to reach profitability?”

「公司的資金是否足夠支撐到開始盈利？」

BT. RUNWAY $\neq$ PROFITABILITY

A business can have:

> long runway

while still losing money.

It simply has enough cash to continue.

Conversely, once reliably cash-flow positive, the simple “months until cash reaches zero” runway calculation may cease to be meaningful in the usual way.

BU. RUNWAY $\neq$ CASH BALANCE

cash balance

how much cash exists now.

runway

how long that cash is expected to last.

Two companies can have the same cash balance but very different runway because their burn rates differ.

BV. RUNWAY $\neq$ BURN RATE

burn rate

cash depletion per month.

runway

months before depletion.

A higher burn rate normally means shorter runway, all else equal.

BW. RUNWAY $\neq$ CASH FLOW

cash flow

cash moving into and out of the business.

runway

time before available cash is exhausted under the assumed cash-flow pattern.

BX. RUNWAY $\neq$ FINANCIAL CUSHION

Your previous target was **cushion**, and the distinction is important.

financial cushion

reserve that absorbs shocks.

runway

how much time those resources give you before you must:

- * become self-sustaining;
- * raise funds;
- * earn income;
- * change course.

A savings reserve can therefore:

> **provide a cushion and create runway.**

BY. RUNWAY IN THE PASSAGE $\neq$ STRICT STARTUP METRIC

This is crucial.

Kam Chai has ****not yet opened the café****.

So when the writer says:

> “use the promotion to build a runway”

it is not necessarily asking him to compute:

> cash ÷ current startup burn.

Instead, it uses startup language more loosely:

> save enough personal and business capital to give himself ****time to experiment and launch without immediate financial desperation****.

That is why the paragraph follows with:

- * 12 months of personal expenses
- * 6 months of basic business costs
- * market research
- * pop-ups
- * customer testing.

So the passage's ****runway**** includes:

> ****money + time + preparation capacity.****

BZ. PERSONAL FINANCIAL RUNWAY

80. ****personal runway = amount of time personal savings can support someone without normal income (個人資金可支撐期) ****

Common extension in:

- * career changes
- * entrepreneurship
- * freelancing.

Example:

> “She saved enough for nine months of runway before quitting.”

「她辭職前儲下了足以維持九個月生活的資金。」

CA. CAREER-CHANGE RUNWAY

81. **career runway = transition time/resources before making a career move**

Less technical than startup **cash runway**.

> build financial runway before leaving employment.

This is close to your passage.

CB. PROJECT / ORGANIZATIONAL RUNWAY

82. **runway = time/resources available before a deadline or constraint forces action**

General business metaphor:

> “The extension gives the project more runway.”

= 「延期讓項目有更多時間 / 資源完成。」

This is broader than cash alone.

CC. REGULATORY / PRODUCT RUNWAY

83. **runway = time available before a future change takes effect**

Business/journalistic:

> “The transition period gives companies more runway to comply.”

= gives them:

> more time to prepare.

A productive figurative extension.

CD. FASHION AND BUSINESS BOTH USE “RUNWAY”

Context is essential:

> “The designer needs more runway.”

Could theoretically mean:

* more stage space;

* more financial/time runway.

Normally surrounding context resolves it.

CE. GENERAL PHYSICAL SENSE: WAY ALONG WHICH SOMETHING RUNS

84. **runway = track/path/channel along which something moves (運行通道 ; 軌道) **

Older/general American dictionary definitions include a broad sense:

> a way, track, channel, chute, groove, or similar path along which something runs or moves. ([柯林斯詞典][13])

This broader physical sense explains several specialist extensions below.

CF. VEHICLE RUNWAY / RAMP

85. **runway = track/ramp used by wheeled vehicles (車輛通道 / 斜道) — specialist**

Collins records a track or ramp for wheeled vehicles as an American use. ([柯林斯詞典][13])

Low priority in modern everyday English.

CG. CRANE RUNWAY

86. **crane runway = 起重機運行軌道**

In industrial/structural engineering:

> the supporting rails/beams along which an overhead travelling crane moves.

CH. RUNWAY BEAM

87. **runway beam = 起重機軌道梁**

A structural beam supporting the crane rails/runway system.

Specialist engineering.

CI. RUNWAY RAIL

88. **runway rail = 運行軌道 / 起重機軌道**

The rail on which a crane/trolley system travels.

CJ. FORESTRY: LOG RUNWAY

89. **runway = chute/path down which logs are moved (運木滑道) — US/Canadian forestry**

Collins records **runway** in forestry as a chute used for sliding logs downhill. ([柯林斯字典API][10])

繁體中文：

* **運木滑道**

* **原木滑道**

Specialist/older.

CK. STREAM CHANNEL / BED

90. **runway = channel or bed of a stream (溪流河床 / 水道) — rare/regional**

Older American dictionary usage records this sense. ([柯林斯詞典][13])

Very low priority today.

CL. ANIMAL RUNWAY = BEATEN PATH

91. **runway = habitual path made by animals (獸徑 ; 動物常走的小徑) **

Especially:

- * deer
- * rodents
- * other wildlife.

Collins records the beaten/habitual path made by deer or other animals as an established American sense. ([柯林斯詞典][13])

CM. RODENT RUNWAY

92. **rodent runway = 鼠類固定活動路徑**

In pest-control/ecology contexts, rodents can create habitual paths along:

- * walls
- * vegetation
- * burrows.

CN. DEER RUNWAY

93. **deer runway = 鹿徑**

A repeatedly used trail made by deer.

Mostly North American/outdoor vocabulary.

CO. ANIMAL ENCLOSURE

94. **runway = enclosure in which domestic animals can move around (動物活動圍欄) — rare**

Some American dictionaries record this sense, essentially similar to:

> an animal run. ([柯林斯詞典][14])

Priority: low.

CP. THEATRE RUNWAY VS FASHION RUNWAY

theatre runway

general narrow extension from a stage into the audience.

fashion runway

that kind of platform specifically used by models.

Thus the fashion sense can be treated as a lexicalized specialization of the stage sense.

CQ. IMPORTANT SPELLING TRAP: RUNWAY vs RUNAWAY

These are completely different words.

runway

- * airport strip
- * fashion catwalk
- * athletic approach
- * financial operating time.

runaway

- * person/animal that has escaped
- * something out of control
- * extremely successful/dominant.

Examples:

> runway train ❌ if you mean uncontrolled train

> runaway train ✅

> runway inflation ❌

> runaway inflation ✅

CR. RUNWAY VS ROAD

road

general route for land vehicles.

runway

specialized path/surface for:

- * aircraft;
- * athletic approach;
- * selected industrial uses.

Do not call an airport runway simply a road.

CS. RUNWAY VS RAMP — AVIATION

runway

takeoff/landing strip.

ramp — especially AmE aviation

aircraft parking/service area.

Completely different.

However, outside aviation, older dictionaries may use **runway** for some kinds of ramps/tracks.

CT. RUNWAY VS FLIGHT DECK

runway

ground/airfield landing surface.

flight deck

aircraft carrier's shipboard takeoff/landing deck.

One would normally say:

> carrier flight deck

not:

> carrier runway.

CU. RUNWAY VS LAUNCH PAD

runway

aircraft accelerates along a path.

launch pad

fixed location from which a rocket launches.

CV. RUNWAY VS APPROACH — ATHLETICS

runway

physical strip/surface.

approach/run-up

the athlete's movement along it.

> athlete performs an approach on the runway.

CW. RUNWAY VS CATWALK — FASHION

As above:

* runway = especially AmE fashion

* catwalk = especially BrE.

For Hong Kong English, both will be understood, but **catwalk** is very natural in British-oriented usage.

CX. RUNWAY VS STAGE

stage

general performance platform.

runway

long narrow extension/path designed for movement/display.

A runway can be part of a stage.

CY. RUNWAY VS PLATFORM

platform

broad raised surface.

runway

specifically elongated path-like platform in fashion/theatre use.

CZ. FINANCIAL RUNWAY VS BREAK-EVEN

runway

how long resources last.

break-even

point where revenue equals relevant costs under the chosen definition.

A business can:

> run out of runway before break-even.

DA. RUNWAY VS PROFIT

profit

economic/accounting surplus.

runway

survival time based on cash availability.

A business can report accounting profit yet still face cash constraints, and a loss-making startup can have substantial runway if sufficiently funded.

DB. RUNWAY VS CAPITAL

capital

resources invested/available to finance a business.

runway

time those resources can support continued operations.

Capital helps create runway.

DC. RUNWAY VS EMERGENCY FUND

emergency fund

specific pool of personal money set aside for unexpected costs.

runway

how much time available resources can sustain you.

For Kam Chai:

> savings = fund

> financial cushion = protective role

> runway = time/options those savings create.

This is a useful three-way distinction.

DD. RUNWAY VS BUFFER

buffer

extra resource protecting against variation.

runway

time/distance available before a hard limit is reached.

Example:

> a cash buffer may extend your runway.

DE. RUNWAY VS DEADLINE

deadline

latest required completion time.

runway

time/resources available leading up to the point where action becomes necessary.

DF. RUNWAY VS LEAD TIME

lead time

time required between initiation and completion/delivery.

runway

time available before resources/permission/opportunity runs out.

DG. RUNWAY VS HORIZON

time horizon

period over which planning/analysis occurs.

runway

available operating time before a constraint is reached.

DH. "BUILD A RUNWAY"

95. **build a runway — literal**

Construct an aircraft runway.

> "The airport plans to build a new runway."

「機場計劃興建新**跑道**。」

96. **build a runway — figurative**

Create enough:

- * capital
- * time
- * preparation
- * optionality

before launching or making a transition.

This is your passage.

Same wording; radically different sense.

DI. "EXTEND THE RUNWAY"

97. literal

Physically make an airport runway longer.

98. figurative

Give a business/person more time before resources run out.

This is a particularly good polysemy pair:

> **extend the runway by 500 metres** — aviation

versus:

> ****extend the runway by six months**** — finance.

DJ. “SHORT RUNWAY”

99. ****short runway — literal****

A physically short airport strip.

100. ****short runway — figurative****

Very little time/cash remaining.

> “The company has a dangerously short runway.”

「公司剩餘的資金可支撐時間很短。」

DK. “LONG RUNWAY”

101. ****long runway — literal****

Long physical landing/takeoff surface.

102. ****long runway — figurative****

Substantial time/resources before a constraint.

May also be used more loosely for:

> long future opportunity for growth.

Example:

> “The technology still has a long runway for growth.”

= still has substantial room/time to develop.

This is a broader business metaphor than strict cash runway.

DL. "RUNWAY FOR GROWTH"

103. **runway for growth = remaining scope/opportunity for future expansion**

Business/investment language.

> "The market offers a long runway for growth."

「這個市場仍有很大的**長期增長空間**。」

Here runway means:

> future room/time/opportunity,

not cash survival.

DM. "RUNWAY AHEAD"

104. **plenty of runway ahead = 還有很多時間 / 發展空間**

Figurative business/journalistic expression.

DN. "RUNWAY TO..." CONSTRUCTION

105. **runway to + milestone/result**

Examples:

* runway to profitability

* runway to launch

* runway to next funding round

* runway to compliance.

Meaning:

> enough time/resources to reach X.

DO. GRAMMAR

106. **on the runway**

Aviation:

> “The aircraft is on the runway.”

Fashion:

> “The model appeared on the runway.”

Same preposition, different meaning.

107. **down the runway**

Aviation:

> aircraft accelerates down the runway.

Athletics:

> athlete runs down the runway.

Fashion:

> model walks down the runway.

This is a striking three-way polysemy pattern.

108. **runway for + noun**

> runway for aircraft

> runway for the long jump.

109. **runway of + time**

Finance commonly prefers:

> six months ****of runway****

rather than:

> ***a runway of six months***,

though the latter is possible.

110. ****X-month runway****

> “The company has a 12-month runway.”

「公司有約十二個月的資金可支撐期。」

111. ****runway to + goal****

> runway to profitability.

112. ****extend / shorten runway****

Both literal and figurative.

113. ****build runway****

Literal or figurative according to context.

DP. COUNTABILITY

Aircraft runway

Countable:

> a runway

> three runways.

Athletics runway

Countable:

> a long-jump runway.

Fashion runway

Countable:

> a runway.

Though fashion phrases such as:

> “on the runway”

often treat it generically.

Animal path / industrial track

Countable:

> a runway.

Financial runway

Often behaves ****mass-like / uncountably****:

> “We need more runway.”

> “We have twelve months of runway.”

But also:

> “a 12-month runway”

is normal.

DQ. FAMILY MAP

Branch	Main meaning
runway — aviation	prepared surface for aircraft takeoff/landing
runway — athletics	approach strip used to build speed before jump/throw
runway — fashion	long narrow catwalk for models
runway — theatre	narrow stage extension into audience
runway — finance/startup	time before available cash is exhausted
runway — general figurative	time/resources/opportunity before a limiting point
runway — path/track	way along which something moves
runway — engineering	crane/vehicle running track
runway — forestry	chute for moving logs
runway — animal trail	habitual beaten path
runway — animal enclosure	enclosed exercise/run area; rare
runway — stream	channel/bed of a stream; rare/regional

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
runway — aircraft	飛機起飛和降落所使用的指定跑道
paved/unpaved runway	鋪裝 / 未鋪裝飛機跑道
runway number/designator	用方向等規則識別跑道的編號
parallel runway	與另一條跑道大致平行的跑道
crosswind runway	為不同風向提供另一操作方向的跑道
runway threshold	可供該方向著陸的跑道起始門檻
displaced threshold	著陸起點被移入跑道內部的移位門檻
runway centreline	沿跑道中央縱向延伸的中線
runway shoulder	跑道兩旁提供額外保護的道肩
runway lighting	供夜間 / 低能見度辨識跑道的燈光系統
runway visual range / RVR	量度飛行員沿跑道可辨認燈光 / 目標距離的跑道視程
runway safety area	飛機偏離 / 衝出跑道時提供額外安全緩衝的區域
runway incursion	飛機、車輛或人員錯誤進入受保護跑道區域的安全事件
runway excursion	飛機起降時偏出、衝出或相關離開跑道表面的事件
runway overrun	飛機超越跑道末端
runway undershoot	飛機在跑道起點之前便著地
active runway / runway in use	當時正在用於起降的跑道
runway closure	跑道因工程、安全等原因暫停使用
wet/contaminated runway	潮濕 / 有水、冰雪等影響性能的跑道
runway capacity	跑道系統在特定條件下可處理航機起降的能力
runway holding position	飛機 / 車輛進入跑道前等待許可的位置
athletics runway	運動員在起跳 / 投擲前加速的助跑道
long-jump runway	跳遠助跑道

triple-jump runway	三級跳助跑道	
pole-vault runway	撐竿跳助跑道	
javelin runway	標槍助跑道	
runway — fashion	模特兒展示時裝時行走的伸展台 / 天橋	
runway show	以模特兒走伸展台展示服裝的時裝秀	
runway model	主要參與時裝秀走台展示的模特兒	
walk the runway	模特兒在時裝天橋上展示服裝	
runway collection/look	在時裝秀展示的系列 / 造型	
runway-ready	達到時裝天橋展示水準、造型完整的	
runway — theatre	從主舞台伸入觀眾席的狹長平台	
cash/startup runway	按現時現金消耗速度計算，企業在現金耗盡前仍可營運多久	
months of runway	尚餘多少個月的資金可支撐期	
extend runway — finance	透過增收、減支或融資增加可繼續營運的時間	
shorten runway	令資金更快耗盡，減少可支撐時間	
run out of runway	資金 / 可支撐時間耗盡	
runway to profitability	足以支撐企業直到達至盈利的資金時間	
personal financial runway	個人失去正常收入後，儲蓄仍可支持生活多久	
build a runway — figurative	累積足夠資金、時間與準備空間才進行重大轉變 / 創業	
long runway for growth	未來仍有很大的發展空間和時間	
runway — general track	物件沿着移動的軌道、滑道或通道；較專門	
crane runway	高架 / 橋式起重機沿着運行的軌道系統	
runway beam	承托起重機軌道的結構梁	
log runway	林業中讓原木向下滑行的滑道	
animal runway	動物長期反覆行走形成的固定獸徑	
animal-enclosure runway	供動物活動的圍欄區；罕見	
runway — stream	溪流的水道 / 河床；罕見地區用法	
runway vs runaway	runway = 跑道 / 資金跑道；runaway = 逃走的、失控的	

For your original passage

> “Instead, use the promotion to ****build a runway****.”

This is one of the strongest metaphors in the paragraph.

Kam Chai currently has:

> salary + promotion + stable income.

The writer wants him to convert those into:

> savings + skills + testing time.

Those resources then become his ****runway****.

The following instructions actually define what that runway should contain:

- > twelve months of personal expenses
- >
- > * six months of basic café costs
- > * research
- > * rent comparisons
- > * break-even calculations
- > * real-world market testing.

So **runway** here is slightly broader than the strict startup-finance meaning.

It means:

> **「讓自己不用一辭職便立即靠咖啡店養活自己的一段財務與時間緩衝。」**

There is also a useful three-word conceptual chain from this passage:

cushion

protects you when a shock happens.

runway

gives you enough time/resources before you reach the point where you must succeed or change course.

capital

is one of the resources that creates that cushion and runway.

For the core database, I would keep **5 principal semantic branches**:

1. **aircraft takeoff/landing surface**
2. **approach track/path along which a person or object builds speed or moves — especially athletics**
3. **fashion/theatrical catwalk or stage extension**
4. **financial/business runway — time before cash/resources run out**
5. **general/specialist physical path or channel — crane track, log chute, animal trail, stream channel, etc.**

Then explicitly index **runway threshold, runway incursion, runway excursion, runway visual range, athletics runway, runway show/model, cash runway, months of runway, extend/run out of runway, long runway for growth, crane runway, and animal runway**, because a database entry reduced simply to **「飛機跑道」** would miss a substantial and very productive modern metaphorical family.

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